

Lava Agni 3

Gimmick or good?

The Lava Agni 3 has taken the mid-range smartphone market in India by storm with its slew of premium features; some innovative, and some copied, or well... inspired by more expensive phones. However, with stiff competition from rivals like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo, OnePlus Nord CE4, and Nothing Phone (2a), which offer advantages in certain specifications, does the Lava Agni 3 have enough to stand out? In this review, we'll explore the phone's strengths and weaknesses to see if it truly delivers on its promises.

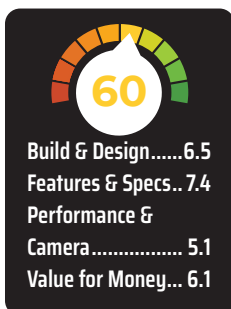
BUILD AND DESIGN

The Lava Agni 3 brings a premium feel with its glass back panel, giving it a distinct edge in terms of aesthetics. However, it lacks any form of display protection, which is a notable drawback, especially compared to competitors like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo and the Nothing Phone (2a), which come with Gorilla Glass 3 and Gorilla Glass 5, respectively. Additionally, while the Agni 3 has an IP64 rating for dust and water resistance, it falls short of the Motorola Edge 50 Neo's IP68 rating, making it less robust against the elements.

Weighing in at a hefty 212 g, the Agni 3 feels solid and sturdy, though its bulk may be a deterrent for users who prefer slimmer, lightweight devices. Holding it for extended periods can feel a bit cumbersome, especially when using the phone in landscape mode for gaming, as the rear display combined with the camera bump can create an uncomfortable grip.

Speaking of the rear display, it is one of the most exciting elements here. You get a 1.74-inch AMOLED display on the back with a 336 x 480 resolution. This mini display is perfect for checking notifications or quickly accessing the camera, though it

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does lack seamless continuity with the main display. More on that later.

Lava has also introduced an Action Button, a welcome addition for a mid-range smartphone that adds a layer of functionality typically found in higher-end devices. Positioned on the right side, the Action Button allows users to customise shortcuts for various functions, from toggling the flashlight to launching apps or activating silent mode with a single press.

Functionally, it's similar to the Action Button on the iPhone 16 series; you can even call it a rip-off. But it's a welcome addition as it gives users the ability to experience the premium feature without spending a fortune.

However, the button's placement can lead to some confusion. It's easy to mistake it for the power button, resulting in unintended actions like accidentally taking a screenshot instead of locking the screen. Despite this minor issue, it's an innovative feature to have at this price. In summary, the Lava Agni 3's design

combines unique elements with some practical drawbacks. While the glass back and secondary display add premium touches, the thicker, heavier build and lack of display protection may be off-putting for some users. For those prioritising distinctive design and functionality, however, the Agni 3 has some compelling aspects to offer.

DISPLAY

The Lava Agni 3 is equipped with not just one, but two AMOLED displays, making it a one-of-a-kind phone in the mid-range market. The main screen is a 6.78-inch 1.5K resolution AMOLED display with 120 Hz refresh rate support, which offers sharp visuals with deep blacks and vibrant colours. It is great for content consumption, especially in HDR. However, the display's peak brightness falls short of Lava's advertised 1200 nits, maxing out at only 898 nits during testing. This lower brightness makes it chal-

lenging to view the screen in direct sunlight, a notable drawback in comparison to the Motorola Edge 50 Neo, which provides superior brightness levels.

Another area where the display falls behind is in its technology. The Motorola Edge 50 Neo boasts an LTPO panel, which not only improves power efficiency but also offers a more dynamic refresh rate experience. Despite these limitations, the display on the Agni 3 still performs well indoors, delivering crisp visuals and rich colour reproduction.

The secondary 1.78-inch AMOLED display also looks great. It offers users a quick-glance panel that's perfect for checking notifications, controlling music playback, viewing the time, or accessing basic functions without flipping the phone over. This display also brings a dash of style and added utility, especially for those who want to stay updated or control apps with a single look.

It's especially useful when using the rear camera, as it can act as a viewfinder for selfies, though this feature comes with limitations. While you can use the rear camera's high-quality sensors for selfies with the secondary display,